

Vili frowned. "If you say so..."

Ve shook his head and laughed. "I think the Sun's dried out your brain, Odin."

*"You two have no imagination," replied Odin. "Where you see dead wood, I see an opportunity to make something special."*

And with that, he puffed out his cheeks and blew life-essence into the trees.

"Ah! Now I see what you mean," Vili said, and together the three gods fashioned the wood into a pair of moving, seeing, hearing and thinking human beings.

*"Splendid," Ve said, stepping back to admire their work. "But what shall we call them?"*

"Well," Odin said. "We formed them from trees, so let's call the man 'Ask' after the ash tree, and the woman 'Embla' after the elm. We should also build them a home close-by so we can keep an eye on them."

So Ask and Embla went to live in Midgard, close to their creators, and became the father and mother of the entire human race.

